PROJECT SYNDICATE DIGEST

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1. The Politics of Poland’s Judicial Crisis

Author: Maciej Kisilowski **Published:** Nov 1, 2026 **Link:** View Original

WARSAW—Dramatic scenes are playing out at Poland’s Constitutional Tribunal amid a wave of speculation about whether Prime Minister Donald Tusk’s government and the Tribunal judges elected by its liberal parliamentary majority are acting lawfully. Many will ask whether democrats must break the law to restore institutions sabotaged by populist authoritarians. In the Polish case, it’s the wrong question.

2. A Tory Mentor for the MAGA GOP

Author: Michael R. Strain **Published:** Nov 2, 2026 **Link:** View Original

WASHINGTON, DC—“There is a fight coming in British politics. A fight that we have not seen in this country for more than half a century. It will be a battle for the soul of this nation. A battle of ideas. A battle that goes to the very core of who we are and what kind of country we want to be.”

3. If AI Thinks for Us, Democracy Will Suffer

Author: John Palfrey **Published:** Nov 2, 2026 **Link:** View Original

CHICAGO—Sometime in the 18th century, the Enlightenment settled a contentious, centuries-old question: Where does knowledge come from? For millennia, many people had pointed to God. But the early modern period brought a new consensus, namely that knowledge comes from human scientists working at the edge of what is known, armed with observation, mathematics, experimentation, and logic.

4. A Debtors’ Club for a Fragmented World

Author: Ishac Diwan **Published:** Nov 2, 2026 **Link:** View Original

BANGKOK—For seven decades, some of the world’s biggest official creditors have coordinated their positions in negotiations with debtor countries struggling with repayment. The Paris Club has sought not only to tackle debt treatment for individual sovereigns, but also to shape the rules governing bailouts and conditionality, largely by leveraging its 22 permanent members’ influence at the International Monetary Fund. Now, the world’s debtors have created a club of their own. The question is whether its stated goals are sufficiently ambitious.

5. Trump’s Tariff Fiasco Could Save Free Trade

Author: Anne O. Krueger **Published:** Nov 2, 2026 **Link:** View Original

WASHINGTON, DC—In the nearly two years since he returned to the White House, US President Donald Trump has picked up where he left off in his first term, shredding the open multilateral trading system that has served the world so well since the end of World War II. He has imposed sweeping tariffs on dozens of countries, repeatedly raising and lowering them and changing rates on individual goods and countries, seemingly on a whim. As a result, US tariff rates are now higher than at any time since the Great Depression’s Smoot-Hawley tariffs.